Functional Requirements Document

Project 1 · Employee Onboarding Optimization

Document purpose. Translate the business needs into testable functional behavior. Specific systems, integrations, fields and SLA values that were not provided are marked for confirmation.

1. System overview

The proposed onboarding workflow coordinates tasks across HR, IT, hiring managers and new employees. It should create a repeatable checklist, assign owners, track due dates and statuses, send targeted notifications, and provide a way to identify incomplete or blocked tasks. This document describes required behavior without assuming that a new standalone application must be built.

Implementation note Confirm whether the workflow will be delivered through existing HR/IT platforms, JIRA, email automation, an onboarding portal or a combination. Integration design depends on that decision.

2. User roles

Role	Permissions / actions
HR coordinator	Create or initiate onboarding cases; verify employee details; monitor HR tasks; close or escalate cases according to policy.
IT / service desk agent	View assigned IT tasks; process approved account, access and equipment requests; update status and blockers.
Hiring manager	Review role-specific requirements; confirm team readiness; complete manager-owned tasks.
New employee	View applicable onboarding instructions; complete assigned actions; acknowledge or submit required information.
Workflow administrator	Maintain task templates, routing rules, SLA settings and notification templates, subject to change control.
Auditor / authorized reviewer	Read relevant status and audit history according to assigned permissions.

3. Functional requirements

ID	Requirement	Acceptance criteria
FR-01	Create an onboarding case from an approved new-hire record or authorized manual initiation.	A unique case/reference is created; required fields are validated; duplicate-case handling is defined.
FR-02	Capture core onboarding information.	At minimum, the configured fields include employee identifier, name, start date, department, role, manager and work location where applicable; missing mandatory fields are flagged.
FR-03	Generate tasks from a configurable onboarding template.	The case receives the correct standard tasks; role/department-specific tasks are added only when the configured rule applies.
FR-04	Assign each task to an owner or responsible role.	Every active task displays an owner, status and due date; unassigned tasks appear in an exception view.
FR-05	Track task status.	Supported statuses include Not Started, In Progress, Blocked, Completed and Cancelled; status changes record actor and timestamp.
FR-06	Calculate task due dates using configured rules and SLAs.	Due dates are calculated from the agreed trigger (for example, case creation or start date); exceptions and non-working-day rules are documented.

FR-07	Send notifications for assigned work and significant events.	The configured recipient receives a notification for assignment, approaching/overdue due dates, blockers and completion where enabled; duplicate notifications are controlled.
FR-08	Escalate overdue or blocked tasks.	Tasks meeting configured escalation rules are surfaced to the responsible lead or queue; the escalation is recorded.
FR-09	Support access-provisioning workflow.	An access task cannot be marked approved/provisioned without the required approval evidence; actual provisioning remains subject to identity-system capabilities and security policy.
FR-10	Provide a readiness view.	Authorized users can see overall onboarding status, incomplete critical tasks, blockers and readiness against the employee start date.
FR-11	Record task history and approvals.	The system retains status transitions, ownership changes, approval decisions and timestamps in an audit trail.
FR-12	Allow authorized users to update or cancel a case.	Changes are permission-controlled; cancellation requires a reason and updates open tasks according to agreed rules.
FR-13	Provide operational reporting.	Authorized users can filter or export cases by start date, department, owner, status, overdue tasks and completion; available fields respect access controls.
FR-14	Handle errors and exceptions.	Failed notifications, missing source data and integration errors are logged and visible to a support owner; retry/manual recovery steps are documented.

4. Business rules

ID	Rule
RULE-01	A case cannot be considered ready while any task marked as critical is incomplete or blocked.
RULE-02	Only authorized roles may approve or request privileged access.
RULE-03	A task must have a responsible owner before it can be considered actively in progress.
RULE-04	Due-date calculations and SLA thresholds must use approved business-calendar rules.
RULE-05	Cancelled onboarding cases must not trigger new routine tasks or notifications, except for explicitly required closure actions.
RULE-06	Employee personal data must be visible only to roles with a business need.

5. Data requirements

Data group	Example fields	Notes / validation
Employee / case	Case ID, employee ID, employee name, start date, department, role, location, manager	Confirm source of truth, mandatory fields and privacy classification.
Task	Task ID, title, description, owner, due date, status, priority, critical flag	Template-driven where possible; task status values should be standardized.
Approval	Approval type, approver, decision, timestamp, comments/reference	Store minimum necessary evidence; follow access-control policy.
Notification	Recipient, event, template, sent time, delivery/error status	Avoid exposing sensitive information in email subject lines or message bodies.
Audit event	Actor, action, record ID, timestamp, before/after values where appropriate	Retention period and access to logs require policy confirmation.

6. Workflow and status logic

1. Initiation: receive or enter new-hire data and validate mandatory fields.
2. Task generation: apply the standard template and any approved role-specific rules.
3. Assignment: route tasks to HR, IT, the manager or the employee; calculate due dates.
4. Execution: owners update task status and provide required completion evidence.

5. Exception handling: flag missing information, blockers, failed notifications and overdue work; route them for resolution.
6. Readiness review: evaluate critical tasks and show a clear Ready / Not Ready state with outstanding items.
7. Closure: authorized owner confirms completion or records cancellation and reason.

7. External systems and interfaces

System / channel	Potential interaction	Open design question
HR system / employee data source	Provide employee and job details; possibly trigger case creation.	Which system is authoritative, and is an API or scheduled file available?
JIRA	Store user stories, requirements, tasks or workflow tickets as agreed.	Is JIRA the operational workflow platform or only the requirements/backlog tool?
Active Directory / identity platform	Support account or group-access tasks where technically approved.	Which provisioning actions are automated, and which require manual approval?
Email / messaging	Send assignments, reminders and escalation messages.	Which mail service, templates, sender identity and delivery monitoring are available?
Reporting tool	Present readiness and process metrics.	Is reporting native to the selected platform or provided separately?

8. Non-functional requirements

Area	Requirement
Security	Use role-based access, least privilege and approved authentication; protect personal and access-related information.
Privacy	Collect and display only data needed for onboarding; apply approved retention and deletion rules.
Auditability	Record important state changes, approvals and exceptions with actor and timestamp.
Reliability	Failures in integrations or notifications must be logged and recoverable without silently losing tasks.
Usability	Users should be able to identify their tasks, due dates, blockers and next actions without navigating unrelated records.
Performance	Response-time and volume targets must be agreed during solution design; do not assume unprovided numeric thresholds.
Accessibility	Follow the organization's accessibility standard and support keyboard navigation where the selected platform allows.
Maintainability	Task templates, routing rules and notification text should be configurable by authorized administrators where feasible.

9. Reporting and KPIs

- Onboarding cases by status, department and start-date range.
- Percentage of new hires marked ready by their start date.
- Number and percentage of overdue or blocked tasks.
- Average time from case initiation to readiness and from task assignment to completion.
- Notification volume and failures; duplicate or avoidable emails where measurable.
- Manual touchpoints before and after the change, using an agreed counting method.
- Sprint-planning duration, if the project team continues to track the reported 30% improvement.

10. Minimum test scenarios

Test ID	Scenario	Expected result
TC-01	Initiate onboarding with all required fields present.	Case is created and correct standard tasks are generated.

TC-02	Initiate onboarding with a mandatory field missing.	Case is rejected or held for correction with a clear validation message.
TC-03	Apply a role-specific onboarding template.	Only applicable conditional tasks are added.
TC-04	Assign a task and update it to Completed.	Owner, status and timestamp are recorded; dependent rules run as configured.
TC-05	Leave a critical task incomplete near the start date.	Readiness remains Not Ready and the task is visible as outstanding.
TC-06	Mark a task Blocked.	Blocker is visible and routed or escalated according to configuration.
TC-07	Attempt privileged access without required approval.	The workflow prevents approval/provisioning completion or flags the policy violation, according to implementation.
TC-08	Simulate notification delivery failure.	Failure is logged and a recovery path is available.
TC-09	User without permission opens a restricted record.	Access is denied or restricted according to the security model.
TC-10	Cancel a case.	Reason is captured and routine open tasks/notifications are handled according to the cancellation rule.
TC-11	Review the audit history.	Authorized reviewer can trace key status and approval changes.
TC-12	Filter readiness report for a date range and department.	Results match underlying case/task data and respect user permissions.

11. Open questions requiring stakeholder confirmation

- What platform will own the operational workflow, and which systems are the sources of truth?
- Which fields are mandatory, and what employee data may be included in notifications?
- What are the agreed SLA values, business calendar, reminder cadence and escalation recipients?
- Which tasks are considered critical for day-one readiness?
- Which access tasks may be automated, and what approvals are required?
- What audit-log and employee-data retention periods apply?
- How will the 30% sprint-planning improvement and approximately 40% reduction in manual touchpoints be baselined and reported?

12. Functional sign-off

The FRD is ready for sign-off when HR, IT, security and the solution owner agree that the requirements are feasible, testable and aligned with policy.

Role	Name	Decision / date
Business analyst / requirements owner	To be completed	To be completed
HR process owner	To be completed	To be completed
IT / solution owner	To be completed	To be completed
Security / identity representative	To be completed	To be completed

Appendix: tools referenced in the project summary

JIRA · BRD/FRD · Swimlane diagrams · MS Visio/Lucidchart · Active Directory · Email workflow mapping